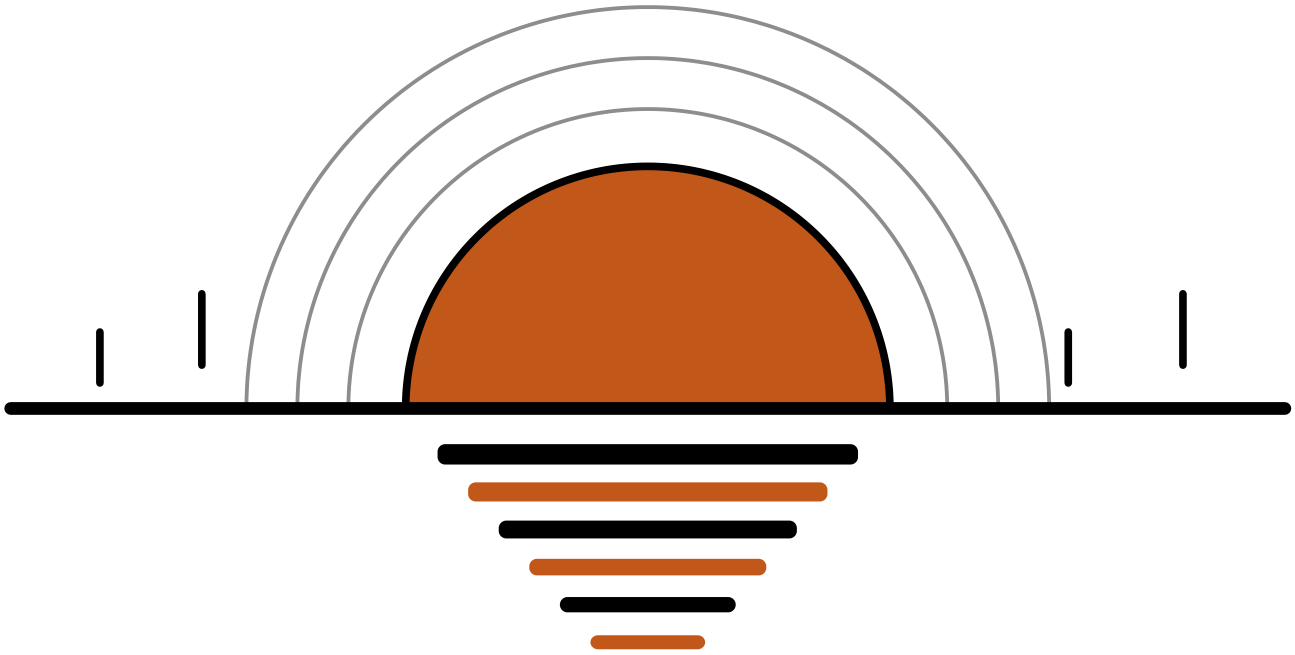
HUDSON BEAT



MAKE MUSIC THAT NEVER SITS STILL
INFINITE HORIZON

DMP2 · ambient · automation · intro slides

GRADES 9–12 · 7 CLASS PERIODS · 23 PAGES + 20-SLIDE DECK

INFINITE HORIZON

How to use this resource

START HERE

Teacher

WHAT THIS IS ·

A 7-class-period open-ended project for high school music technology. Each student builds a 60–90 second ambient soundscape in Logic: a drone or pad, more layers, and automation on filters, reverb, volume and panning so the sound is always moving. There is no beat and no song form. They bounce it, reflect and present it with Padlet questions for feedback. It is the project from my Digital Music Production 2 course (type: open-ended; focus: automation and texture), and the projects in that course can be taught in any order.

QUICK START ·

1. Read the pacing guide (page 5) and my teacher notes (pages 6–7).
2. Choose your listening examples, set up the Presentation Padlet and decide your minimum number of automation lanes (page 4).
3. Print the student pages (pages 12–22), one set per student.
4. Open the intro deck and read the speaker notes for Class 1.

THE INTRO DECK ·

Every slide has a class: Class 1 (slides 1–7), Class 2 (slides 8–10), Class 3 (slides 11–13), Class 4 (slides 14–15), Class 6 (slides 16–18) and Class 7 (slides 19–20). Class 5 is a working day with no new slide. Every slide has speaker notes.

Fonts: the deck uses Oswald and Source Sans 3 (free on Google Fonts, built into Google Slides). If PowerPoint or Keynote shows a different font, install the two fonts or present the PDF copy, which shows the intended look.

WHAT'S INSIDE ·

PART	PAGES	USE
Teacher pages	pages 2–11	How to use, overview, setup, pacing, teacher notes, what changed, Logic quick reference, starter template and Harder variation, worked example
Student pages	pages 12–22	Listening log, Phase plan, Automation plan, Listen-back sheet, project sheet (3 pages), rubric, vocabulary, feedback planner, reflection
Intro deck (separate file)	deck	20 slides, .pptx + PDF, speaker notes on every slide

NO AUDIO INCLUDED

No audio, video, songs, artists or albums are named or included. You choose what to play for the listening on Class 1, and students make every sound in their soundscapes themselves.

MAKE IT FIT YOUR CLASS ·

- **Easier or harder:** my variations on page 6: a starter template with one drone layer and basic automation (a recipe for it is on page 10), or 2+ minutes, at least 5 automation lanes and Alchemy.
- **Feedback board:** my sheets use Padlet for the three questions; any class board works.
- **Any sound:** the pages name no instrument or sound source beyond the owner's, so students fill in their own.
- **Grading:** my rubric, /25, the average of the student's and your score (page 19).

IN ONE SENTENCE

Students build a soundscape that never sits still, and learn that automation is how a sound moves.

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INFINITE HORIZON

Project overview

OVERVIEW

DMP2 · Open-ended

FROM MY DMP2 PROJECT MENU

Infinite Horizon · Open-Ended · Automation & Texture

Create an evolving ambient soundscape through automation and modulation. Focus on motion, texture, and space.

WHAT STUDENTS MAKE ·

One evolving ambient soundscape, 60–90 seconds long, with no traditional rhythm or song structure. It is built from layered textures and drones using synths, samples and FX, with automation of parameters such as filters, reverb and volume, and with gradual transitions. They hand in a bounced .mp3 or .wav and the zipped .logicx project, plus a Padlet post with three feedback questions, then play the piece and present it.

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

Deep dive into automation, modulation, and effects processing. Challenges students to think about music as atmosphere rather than structure.

STANDARDS ·

Supports the National Core Arts Standards for Music (Music Technology, high school): generating and developing ideas (MU:Cr1.1, MU:Cr2.1), presenting work (MU:Pr6.1) and responding to it (MU:Re7.2).

GOALS ·

- Use automation and modulation to create evolving, non-repeating textures
- Layer ambient sounds, drones, synths, and effects for depth
- Explore how sound can create mood and atmosphere without traditional structure
- Build a 60–90 second soundscape that sustains listener interest

AT A GLANCE ·

Grades	9–12: the second-year course, after a first year of Logic Pro basics
Length	7 class periods: listen and build a drone, layer, three working days, mix and bounce, present
Software	Logic Pro: synths, effects, automation, mixing, bounce
You supply	Macs with Logic Pro, headphones, ambient examples of your choice to play, a feedback board and a place to submit files
Assessment	My rubric, 5 categories scored 1–5, /25; final grade = average of the student's and the teacher's score (page 19)

BEFORE THEY START

Students should already know how to open a project, add and play software instruments, use the Mixer, and save, bounce and zip in Logic. Nothing new is taught: the quick reference (page 9) shows where each tool lives, including automation.

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INFINITE HORIZON

Setup and what to watch

SETUP

Teacher

YOU NEED ·

- **A Mac with Logic Pro** for each student, and **headphones**. Speakers help for the final listen.
- **Ambient examples of your choice** to play on Class 1 and as your "compelling examples" (my fourth struggle). None is included.
- **A place to submit** the .mp3 or .wav and the zipped .logicx (your class page).
- **The Presentation Padlet**, set up before Class 1 (yours to set up; none is included).
- **A minimum number of automation lanes** (my second struggle). Write it on the board and on page 14.
- **Printed student pages**, one set each (pages 12–22).

BEFORE CLASS 1 ·

- ☐ Choose two or three ambient examples to play, and decide what students listen for.
- ☐ Set up the Presentation Padlet in your class page.
- ☐ Decide your minimum number of automation lanes and your rule for the starter template (page 10).
- ☐ Check that a student computer opens Logic and plays back through headphones.

WHAT TO WATCH (MY FOURTH STRUGGLE AND CLOSING NOTE) ·

Some students find ambient music boring, and many add a beat. This project stretches students' definition of what music can be. Pair with a brief discussion of ambient and experimental music history.

KIT SUGGESTIONS, NOT PART OF MY SHEETS

- A minimum of three automation lanes works for most classes; use five for my Harder variation. The number is yours to set.
- While students work, ask: what is moving in your piece right now? What was the last change you could hear?
- Short, quiet listening works best with eyes closed and the lights low. Keep it to a minute or two.

MUSIC THEY DID NOT MAKE ·

A KIT SUGGESTION

The sheet allows samples. Tell students to use only audio they made or have the right to use, and to hand in only their own soundscape. Examples you play for listening stay out of their projects.

KEEP THE VOLUME MODERATE

Slow, low drones can hide how loud a piece is. Tell students to start with the headphones low and to check the final mix at a normal level.

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INFINITE HORIZON

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

PACING

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

CLASS	MY PLAN	TEACHER MOVES	DECK	STUDENT PAGES
CLASS 1	**Class 1:** Introduction. Listen to ambient examples. Begin building a drone/pad foundation.	Slides 1–7: hook, what the project is, the steps, five words, steps 1 and 2. Hand out the project sheet and the Listening log. You choose and play the examples; none is included.	Slides 1–7	p. 12, p. 16, p. 17, p. 18, p. 20
CLASS 2	**Class 2:** Layer additional textures and atmospheric elements.	Slides 8–10: four phases, texture not rhythm, step 3. Hand out the Phase plan. Check each drone layer is in place.	Slides 8–10	p. 13
CLASS 3	**Classes 3–5:** Working days — automate, refine, evolve the soundscape.	Slides 11–13: automate everything, step 4 and the worked example on paper. Hand out the Automation plan. Then work time.	Slides 11–13	p. 14
CLASS 4		Slides 14–15: patience, and refine. Hand out the Listen-back sheet. Then work time.	Slides 14–15	p. 15
CLASS 5		Full working day: automate, refine, evolve. Ask each student to play the first 20 seconds and say what changes in it.	No new slides	—
CLASS 6	**Class 6:** Final mix, bounce. Prepare presentations.	Slides 16–18: mix and bounce, what to turn in, the rubric. Students post their three Padlet questions.	Slides 16–18	p. 19, p. 21
CLASS 7	**Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback.	Slides 19–20: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions. Reflection (page 22) follows the presentations.	Slides 19–20	p. 21, p. 22

THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

Say it twice: this is texture and motion, not rhythm (my first struggle). If a student adds a beat, ask what they would hear if the beat were taken out.

CLASSES 3–5

Working days; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate with one question: what is moving in your piece right now?

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INFINITE HORIZON

Teacher notes · the big idea

WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

Deep dive into automation, modulation, and effects processing. Challenges students to think about music as atmosphere rather than structure.

COMMON STUDENT STRUGGLES ·

- Students default to adding beats. Remind them this is about texture and motion, not rhythm.
- Soundscapes feel static because students don't automate enough parameters. Require a minimum number of automation lanes.
- Students struggle without traditional structure to guide them. Suggest thinking in phases: opening, evolution, climax, fade.
- Some students find ambient music boring. Play compelling examples.

SUGGESTED VARIATIONS ·

Easier: Provide a starter template with one drone layer and basic automation. Students add layers on top.

More Advanced: Extend to 2+ minutes. Require at least 5 automation lanes and use of Alchemy for custom ambient patches.

WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH EACH STRUGGLE

- Adding beats: slide 9 and the Listen-back sheet's "no beat crept in" check (page 15).
- Too little automation: the Automation plan (page 14), with a box for the minimum you set.
- No structure to guide them: the four phases on slide 8 and the Phase plan (page 13).
- Ambient seems boring: the Listening log (page 12) asks what changes, which gives listening a job.

WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH THE VARIATIONS (KIT SUGGESTION)

- Easier: the starter-template recipe, to build on paper's instructions in a few minutes (page 10).
- More advanced: the worked example has five lanes (page 11); page 10 lays out 2+ minutes, 5+ lanes and Alchemy.

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SUGGESTED RESOURCES ·

MY LIST	IN THIS KIT
An ambient album for reference listening (named in my notes)	Not named here, and no audio is included: choose your own listening for Class 1 and your compelling examples (my fourth struggle). The Listening log (page 12) is where students write what they hear.
Ambient music production tutorials on YouTube	Kept as I wrote it. No tutorial, video or link is included. The Logic quick reference (page 9) says where each tool lives.
Logic Pro automation tutorial	Kept as I wrote it. No video is included. The Automation plan (page 14) and the quick reference show what to draw and where.

HOW TO GRADE ·

- My rubric: five categories, each scored 1–5, /25 (page 19). Students score themselves first; the final grade is the average of their score and yours.

Suggestions from this kit, not part of my rubric:

- Creativity & Originality: ask what mood or place the student was after, then listen for it with your eyes closed (my fourth tip).
- Technical Skill: open the project and show the automation lanes (page 14). Count them against the minimum you set.
- Composition & Structure: compare the piece with the Phase plan (page 13). Is there a clear opening, evolution, climax and fade, with no beat?
- Sound Design & Mix Quality: listen for depth and space (step 6). Which layers sit far away, which close?
- Documentation & Presentation: the Listening log, the Automation plan, the Reflection page (page 22) and the Padlet questions are the evidence.

REFLECTION · ADDED BY THIS KIT ·

The rubric mentions reflection, but the project sheet has no reflection task, so this kit adds one (page 22): a written or oral conversation about how you did on the project and what you would do differently next time. Students write it or talk it through with you; either way they answer the four prompts. Allow about 10 minutes after the presentations. It adds no points and no rubric row; use it as evidence when you score Documentation & Presentation.

NOTES / OBSERVATIONS ·

This project stretches students' definition of what music can be. Pair with a brief discussion of ambient and experimental music history.

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INFINITE HORIZON

What changed from the original

CHANGES

Teacher

This kit is built from three of my documents: the **Project Sheet & Rubric**, the **Teacher Notes** and the **Infinite Horizon** entry on my DMP2 project menu. This page lists every change to my wording, so you know exactly what is mine and what was added.

WORDING CHANGES ·

- My LMS name is written as “your class page” (checklist items 1 and 2).
- Page numbers are added to steps 1, 2, 4 and 5 (the Listening log, Phase plan, Automation plan and Listen-back sheet).
- **No artist or album is named.** My fourth struggle names three artists and my first resource names an album and its artist, for reference listening. This kit names no artist and includes no audio, so my fourth struggle reads “Play compelling examples.” and my first resource is listed as “An ambient album for reference listening (named in my notes)”. You choose what to play.
- My Easier variation (a starter template with one drone layer and basic automation) is a Logic project, which is not included. It is laid out as a recipe on paper (page 10) so you can build it in a few minutes.
- My Harder variation (2+ minutes, at least 5 automation lanes, Alchemy for custom ambient patches) is laid out on page 10. My second struggle asks you to require a minimum number of automation lanes; the number is yours to set.
- My resources about YouTube tutorials and a Logic Pro automation tutorial are listed as I wrote them. No tutorial or link is included.
- My pacing guide’s “Classes 3–5” row spans the Class 3, 4 and 5 rows, so each class can name its slides.
- Layout only: the rubric’s Name and Date lines moved to the top; its Notes box became ruled lines.
- The intro deck shortens my wording (full wording on pages 16–18): slide 3 shortens my overview and a goal, slide 6 shortens my five vocabulary definitions, slide 7 shortens steps 1 and 2, slide 9 shortens my first struggle and requirement 5, slide 10 shortens step 3 and requirement 2, slide 12 shortens step 4 and requirements 3 and 4, slide 14 shortens tips 1 to 3, slide 15 shortens step 5, tip 4 and the Harder variation, slide 16 shortens steps 6 and 7, slide 17 shortens the submission checklist, and slide 19 shortens step 7.
- **Reflection added (page 22).** My rubric mentions reflection, but the project sheet has no reflection task. This kit adds one, following my definition: a written or oral conversation about how the student did on the project and what they would do differently next time. It adds no points and no rubric row.

KEPT AS I WROTE IT ·

Everything else from my three documents is kept as I wrote it: the overview, goals, five vocabulary terms, five requirements, steps (apart from the page numbers), tips, checklist (apart from the class page) and file name (“Your Name – Infinite Horizon”), the /25 rubric, what the project reinforces, my first three struggles, the variations, my closing note and the project menu entry on page 3. No rubric row is added and the requirements are unchanged.

NEW IN THIS KIT ·

Everything else is new and supports my sheets without changing them: the how-to, overview and setup pages, the teacher moves in the pacing guide, the grading suggestions, the suggested minimum of three automation lanes (a kit suggestion on page 4), the Logic quick reference, the starter-template recipe and Harder variation page, the worked example (an invented 75-second piece, its phases, layers and automation lanes, on paper, not audio), the Listening log, Phase plan, Automation plan and Listen-back sheet, the vocabulary and presentation pages and the intro deck. None adds a requirement or a rubric row. The one addition that asks something of students is the Reflection page (page 22), explained under Wording changes; the rubric is unchanged.

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INFINITE HORIZON

Logic quick reference

SETUP

Teacher + student

Where to find the tools an Infinite Horizon project is likely to use. Demonstrate what your class needs on Classes 1 and 3 and then let students work. Names are from current Logic Pro versions; check the labels on yours.

New project and tracks	File › New…, then add tracks with Track › New Tracks…: a Software Instrument track for synths and pads, an Audio track for samples and recordings.
A drone or pad	On a Software Instrument track open the Library (Y) and browse the pad and synth sounds. Draw one long region with a held note or chord and loop it, so the sound never stops.
Synths and samples	Alchemy (my Harder variation) and the other software instruments make drones and textures. Drop audio you own onto an Audio track, or load it in Quick Sampler, to build a texture.
Automation	Press A to show automation, choose a parameter such as a filter cutoff, volume, pan or a reverb send, and click to add points on the lane. Drag points to shape the curve.
Modulation	Many synth sounds have LFOs and envelopes that move a parameter for you. In Alchemy, look at the modulation section. Automation is you drawing the change; modulation is a signal doing it.
Filters and EQ	Add Channel EQ or use a synth's own filter. Automating a filter cutoff slowly opens or closes the sound.
Reverb and delay	Insert Space Designer or ChromaVerb, or send tracks to a bus with a reverb or delay on it. Automate the send level to change how much space a sound has.
Mixer: volume and panning	Press X to open the Mixer. Move each track's fader for volume and its Pan knob to place it, then automate both.
Save versions	Use File › Save As… with a numbered name before each big change.
Length check	Look at the position display: a 60–90 second piece ends between 1:00 and 1:30 at the project's tempo.
Bounce and zip	File › Bounce › Project or Section (Command-B), MP3 or WAV. In Finder, Control-click the .logicx and choose Compress.

VERSION NOTE

Menu names are from current Logic Pro versions; older versions may differ slightly. Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc., named only to describe what the project needs. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

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INFINITE HORIZON

Starter template and my Harder variation

TEACHER

Easier + Harder

My Easier variation: provide a starter template with one drone layer and basic automation; students add layers on top. A Logic project is not included in this kit, so here is a recipe for it. Build it yourself in a few minutes, with sounds you have the right to use.

STARTER TEMPLATE: ONE DRONE LAYER, BASIC AUTOMATION ·

1. New Software Instrument track; open the Library (Y) and pick a pad or drone sound.
2. Draw one long region (8 to 16 bars) with a held note or chord, and cycle it so the sound never stops.
3. Add a filter: the synth's own cutoff or Channel EQ. Press A and choose its cutoff on the lane.
4. Draw a slow curve: closed at the start, open by the middle, partly closed at the end. This is the "basic automation".
5. Add a reverb send, set it moderate, and automate nothing else yet. Save as "Starter".
6. Open it for each student (or share it on your class page). They add layers on top, as my Easier variation says.

MY HARDER VARIATION, LAID OUT ·

MY OPTION	HOW TO USE IT
Extend to 2+ minutes	The worked example (page 11) is 75 seconds, so at 2 minutes each phase is about a third longer. Students replan the four phases on page 13 for 120 seconds or more.
At least 5 automation lanes	The worked example has five lanes. Students list them on page 14 and you count them.
Alchemy for custom ambient patches	Students build or edit a drone or pad patch in Alchemy rather than picking one from the Library. Show the source and filter sections and the modulation section (page 9).

HOW TO USE THIS PAGE

Offer the starter to students who freeze at the empty project; nobody has to take it. Offer the Harder variation to students who finish early. Both are your choice, as in my notes. The 60–90 second length is the rule for everyone else (requirement 1).

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INFINITE HORIZON

Worked example · an invented piece

EXAMPLE

Teacher

An **invented piece, "Slow Tide", described on paper**: no audio is included. Students' projects will differ.

1 · A WEAK PLAN

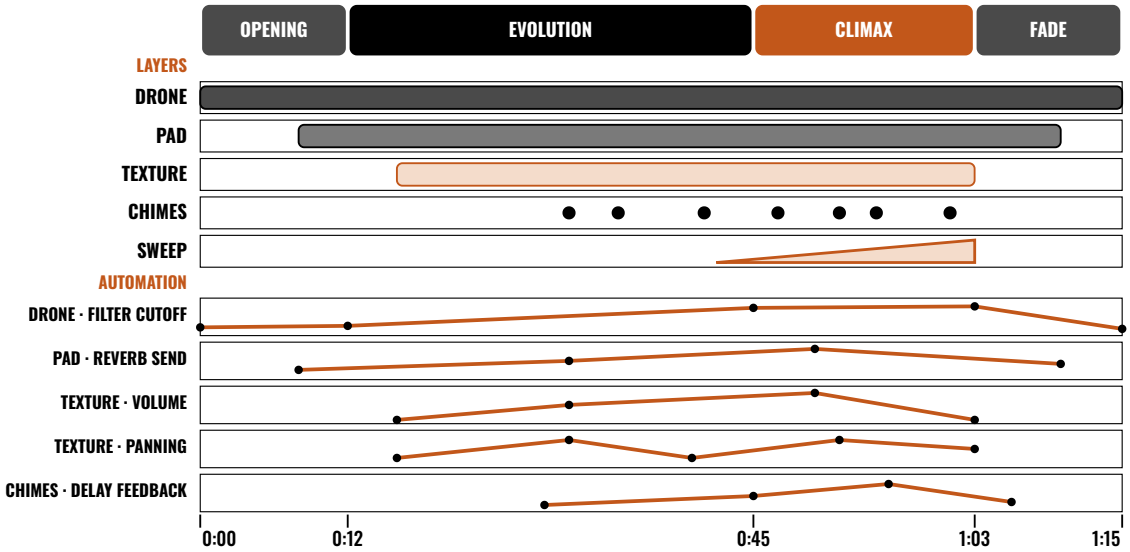
I will make a calm ambient track with a soft beat.

It has a beat, and nothing says what will change.

2 · A CLEAR PLAN

I am making "Slow Tide", a 75-second soundscape about the sea coming in. It has no beat. It opens with a low drone, a pad joins at 8 seconds, and noise and bell notes arrive in the evolution. I will automate the drone's filter, the pad's reverb, the texture's volume and panning and the chimes' delay: five lanes, so nothing stays the same. It climbs to a swell at 45 seconds and fades to the drone alone.

3 · THE MAP: 1:15, FOUR PHASES, FIVE LAYERS, FIVE LANES ·



4 · PHASES

Opening	0:00–0:12	the drone alone, filter nearly closed; the pad joins at 0:08
Evolution	0:12–0:45	texture and chimes arrive; the filter and reverb open slowly; the texture pans left and right
Climax	0:45–1:03	the sweep rises, everything is at its fullest and widest, the chimes echo the most
Fade	1:03–1:15	texture and sweep leave, the pad fades, the filter closes on the drone

5 · LAYERS (IN TO OUT)

Drone	one low, sustained synth chord that never stops	0:00–1:15
Pad	a soft, wide synth pad that slowly joins	0:08–1:10
Texture	filtered noise, like wind far away	0:16–1:03
Chimes	a few soft bell notes, no pulse, long reverb	0:28–1:06
Sweep	a noise swell that rises into the climax	0:42–1:03

6 · AUTOMATION LANES

Drone · filter cutoff	0:00–1:15
Pad · reverb send	0:08–1:10
Texture · volume	0:16–1:03
Texture · panning	0:16–1:03
Chimes · delay feedback	0:28–1:06

7 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS

12 + 33 + 18 + 12 = 75 s = 1:15, inside my 60–90 second range. Five lanes, my Harder variation's minimum, and every one moves a lot. **Three Padlet questions (invented):** 1. Where did you first notice something change? 2. Which layer could you hear moving, and which was still? 3. Did your eyes-closed picture match the title?

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INFINITE HORIZON

Listening log

STUDENT

Class 1

Name _____ Date _____

Step 1: study examples of ambient and soundscape music for inspiration. Your teacher chooses and plays the examples. Close your eyes, listen for a minute, then write what you notice. Soundscape: an ambient composition focused on texture and atmosphere rather than melody or rhythm.

WHAT I NOTICE	EXAMPLE 1	EXAMPLE 2	EXAMPLE 3
What I hear (sounds, in order)			
What stays the same			
What changes over time			
How it makes me feel			
What is NOT there (a beat? a melody?)			

WHAT THE EXAMPLES SHARE

The longest sound I heard lasted about: _____

Something that changed so slowly I almost missed it: _____

A change I could hear in space (reverb, echo, near or far): _____

One thing I will try in my own soundscape: _____

CHECK

- ☐ I wrote down what changed, not only what I liked.
- ☐ I listened with my eyes closed at least once.

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INFINITE HORIZON

Phase plan

STUDENT

Classes 1–2

Name _____ Date _____

Steps 2 and 3: create a drone or pad layer as your base texture, then add additional textures, sounds, and atmospheric elements. Plan the piece in four phases: opening, evolution, climax, fade (from my teacher notes). A drone is a sustained tone or chord that creates a foundation for ambient music.

MY FOUNDATION (STEP 2)

My drone or pad sound is: _____

It plays the note or chord: _____ **Made with (synth, sample, FX):** _____

OPENING · FROM ___ TO ___ SECONDS

Layers I hear: _____

What moves or changes: _____

How it should feel: _____

EVOLUTION · FROM ___ TO ___ SECONDS

Layers I hear: _____

What moves or changes: _____

How it should feel: _____

CLIMAX · FROM ___ TO ___ SECONDS

Layers I hear: _____

What moves or changes: _____

How it should feel: _____

FADE · FROM ___ TO ___ SECONDS

Layers I hear: _____

What moves or changes: _____

How it should feel: _____

Total length (60–90 seconds): _____ **Layers in all:** _____ **No beat?** _____

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INFINITE HORIZON

Automation plan

STUDENT

Classes 3–5

Name _____ Date _____

Step 4: draw automation on filters, reverb, volume, and panning to create evolution. Automation is changing a parameter over time to create movement and evolution. Each lane is one parameter on one track. Automate everything: if a parameter stays the same the whole time, your soundscape will feel flat.

My teacher's minimum number of lanes: _____ **My lanes so far:** _____

#	TRACK AND PARAMETER	STARTS AT TO	FROM TIME TO TIME	DOES IT MOVE SLOWLY? DONE?
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				

PARAMETERS TO TRY (FROM MY SHEET AND THE QUICK REFERENCE)

Filter cutoff · reverb send · delay send or feedback · volume · panning · a synth's modulation depth. Modulation is using one signal to control another, adding variation and life to a sound.

The lane that changes the most: _____

The lane I will slow down: _____

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INFINITE HORIZON

Listen-back sheet

STUDENT

Classes 4–6

Name _____ Date _____

Step 5: listen for flow and pacing. Remove anything that feels static or repetitive. Close your eyes while listening to your piece. Does it take you somewhere? That's the goal.

EYES-CLOSED LISTEN

Where it took me: _____

The first moment I noticed a change (time): _____ **The last:** _____

Where my attention drifted (time): _____

STATIC OR REPETITIVE SPOTS ·

TIME	WHAT FEELS STATIC OR REPETITIVE	WHAT I CHANGED

CHECKS BEFORE I BOUNCE

- ☐ Every layer changes at least once (an automation lane or a sound that moves).
- ☐ Nothing repeats exactly, and no beat crept in.
- ☐ The transitions between phases are gradual.
- ☐ The piece is between 60 and 90 seconds.
- ☐ Reverb or delay gives it a sense of space.
- ☐ I mixed for depth and space (step 6).

The one change that improved my piece most: _____

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Name _____ Date _____

INFINITE HORIZON

Digital Music Production | *Open-Ended Project* | 7 class periods

OVERVIEW ·

Create a soundscape that never sits still. Design an evolving ambient piece that continuously transforms through automation, modulation, and layering. No traditional rhythm or song structure — this is about motion, texture, and space.

GOALS ·

- Use automation and modulation to create evolving, non-repeating textures
- Layer ambient sounds, drones, synths, and effects for depth
- Explore how sound can create mood and atmosphere without traditional structure
- Build a 60–90 second soundscape that sustains listener interest

KEY VOCABULARY ·

Soundscape	An ambient composition focused on texture and atmosphere rather than melody or rhythm
Drone	A sustained tone or chord that creates a foundation for ambient music
Automation	Changing a parameter over time to create movement and evolution
Modulation	Using one signal to control another, adding variation and life to a sound
Ambient	Music focused on tone, atmosphere, and texture rather than traditional song structure

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INFINITE HORIZON

STUDENT

Project sheet · requirements and steps

Name _____ Date _____

REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Length: 60–90 seconds
- ☐ Layer ambient textures and drones using synths, samples, and FX
- ☐ Use automation to change parameters over time (filters, reverb, volume)
- ☐ Incorporate gradual transitions and evolving movement
- ☐ Avoid traditional rhythm or song structure — focus on motion and space

STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Listen** — Study examples of ambient and soundscape music for inspiration (Listening log: page 12)
2. **Build your foundation** — Create a drone or pad layer as your base texture (Phase plan: page 13)
3. **Layer** — Add additional textures, sounds, and atmospheric elements
4. **Automate** — Draw automation on filters, reverb, volume, and panning to create evolution (Automation plan: page 14)
5. **Refine** — Listen for flow and pacing. Remove anything that feels static or repetitive. (Listen-back sheet: page 15)
6. **Finalize** — Mix for depth and space. Bounce your soundscape.
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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INFINITE HORIZON

Project sheet · tips and checklist

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

TIPS FOR SUCCESS ·

- This project is about patience. Let sounds evolve slowly — don't rush changes.
- Reverb and delay are your best friends here. Use them to create a sense of space.
- Automate everything. If a parameter stays the same the whole time, your soundscape will feel flat.
- Close your eyes while listening to your piece. Does it take you somewhere? That's the goal.

SUBMISSION CHECKLIST ·

- ☐ Bounced .mp3 or .wav uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Zipped .logicx project file uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Files named correctly: "Your Name – Infinite Horizon"
- ☐ Padlet post created with your 3 feedback questions
- ☐ Answered at least 2 questions on classmates' Padlet posts during presentations

NOTES ·

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INFINITE HORIZON

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

GRADING RUBRIC /25

Infinite Horizon | Open-Ended Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

Category	1	2	3	4	5
CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY	Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés	Some creative ideas but largely predictable	Shows originality; experiments with sound or style	Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent	Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive
TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE	Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools	Basic tool use with frequent errors	Competent workflow; uses tools correctly	Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts	Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems
COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE	Disorganized; no clear form or direction	Some structure present but underdeveloped	Clear, cohesive form with logical sections	Engaging structure with dynamic progression	Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc
SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY	Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix	Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ	Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix	Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix	Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Missing or incomplete; no reflection	Minimal documentation with little insight	Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection	Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection	Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery

Student Score: _____ / 25	Teacher Score: _____ / 25
Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25	

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INFINITE HORIZON

Key vocabulary

STUDENT

Vocabulary

Name _____ Date _____

The five words from your project sheet, with my definitions. Rewrite each in your own words, then show where it happens in your own project.

SOUNDSCAPE — An ambient composition focused on texture and atmosphere rather than melody or rhythm

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my soundscape: _____

DRONE — A sustained tone or chord that creates a foundation for ambient music

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my soundscape: _____

AUTOMATION — Changing a parameter over time to create movement and evolution

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my soundscape: _____

MODULATION — Using one signal to control another, adding variation and life to a sound

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my soundscape: _____

AMBIENT — Music focused on tone, atmosphere, and texture rather than traditional song structure

In my own words: _____

Where it shows up in my soundscape: _____

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INFINITE HORIZON

Present and get feedback

STUDENT

Classes 6–7

Name _____ Date _____

FROM YOUR PROJECT SHEET, STEP 7

Present & Get Feedback — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

MY THREE FEEDBACK QUESTIONS ·

Ask about things you really want to know, not yes-or-no questions.

Question 1: _____

Question 2: _____

Question 3: _____

CLASSMATES' QUESTIONS I ANSWERED (AT LEAST 2) ·

CLASSMATE	THEIR QUESTION	MY ANSWER

BEFORE I PRESENT ·

- ☐ Files named "Your Name – Infinite Horizon"; the .mp3 or .wav and zipped .logicx submitted
- ☐ Padlet post created with my 3 questions
- ☐ Rubric self-score done (page 19)

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INFINITE HORIZON

Reflection · how did it go?

STUDENT

After presenting

Name _____ Date _____

WHAT A REFLECTION IS

A reflection is a written or oral conversation about how you did on the project and what you would do differently next time. Answer all four prompts in your own words. You choose how.

☐ **Written.** I will write my answers on this page.

☐ **Oral.** I will talk my answers through with my teacher. My teacher fills in the box at the bottom.

1 **What went well?** Name something in your project you are proud of, and say why it worked.

2 **What did you struggle with?** Say what was hard and what you tried to fix it.

3 **What would you do differently next time?** Be specific: a step, a choice, a sound or a tool.

4 **Look at the rubric (page 19).** Which category are you proudest of, and which would you work on first next time?

ORAL REFLECTION · TEACHER

Date: _____ **Prompts covered (1-4):** _____

Key points I heard: _____

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QUESTIONS?

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CREDITS

- Project sheet, rubric, teacher notes and intro deck: original work by Brian Lotze, Hudson Beat.
- Worked example (an invented 75-second piece with its phases, layers and automation lanes, described on paper), the horizon, step, phase and automation drawings and layouts: original work, Hudson Beat.
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